A/B TEST EXPERIMENT EVALUATION

# Redesigning the Digital Client Journey

A review of the recent A/B test investigating the impact of clean layouts and in-context cues on client completion rates.

CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE (CX) TEAM

CLAIRE AND BIBIAN

JUNE 2026

# THE DIGITAL CHALLENGE

**We wanted to find out if small interventions could help more users complete online processes.**

Many users struggle or hesitate during online forms. The team hypothesized that a cleaner visual layout paired with timely, in-context hints would simplify the process.

### Control Group

The standard transactional layout currently live on the site.

### Test Group

An updated interface with real-time in-context guidance.

# IMPROVEMENTS IN KEY PERFORMANCE METRICS

The results show that the test group outperformed the control group in completion rate and completion times despite an increase in error rates.

**60.4%**

**COMPLETION RATE**

An **increase of 4.9 percent** over the legacy layout's 55.6% benchmark.

**195s**

**MEDIAN TIME**

Completers in the test group finished the task **40 seconds faster** than the control group.

**13.4%**

**FIRST STEP DROPOUT**

A **7.5 percent drop** in abandonments right at the start of the journey.

# DEFINING EXCLUSION CRITERIA

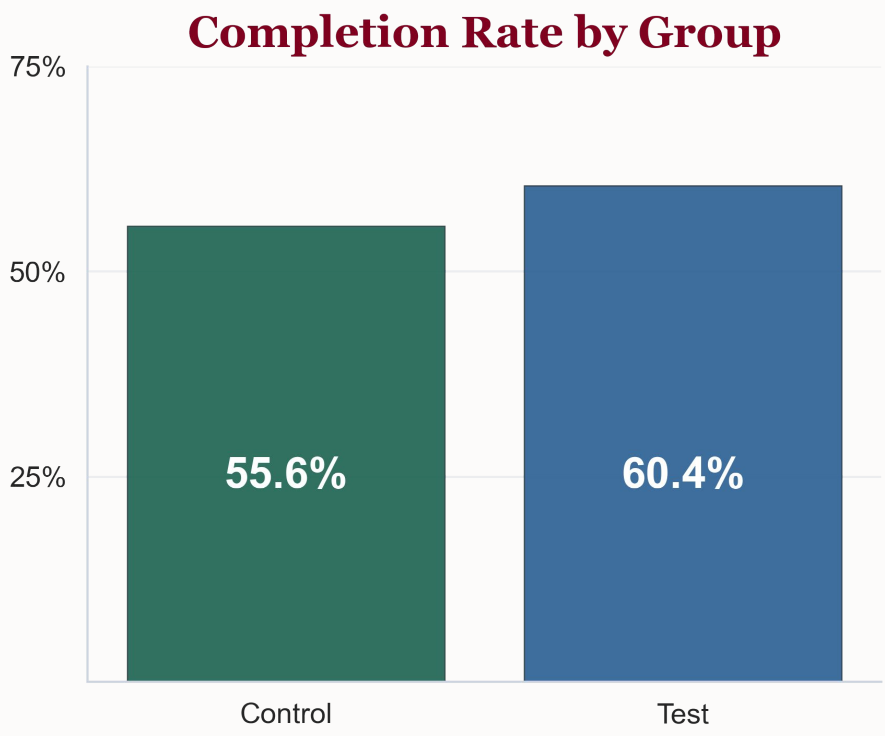
## Who was included in analysis?

- Only clients that commenced the process after the study onset were included.
- Clients that were active during last 20 minutes but did not confirm were excluded.
- Only last completion attempt was considered.

This resulted in sample sizes of 22,934 and 25,388 for control and test groups, respectively. A demographic breakdown can be found on [Tableau.]


[Visit our Tableau Dashboard]

# HIGHER COMPLETION RATE IN TEST CONDITION




### Did the redesign help convert more users?

Yes. The test layout achieved a **60.4%** completion rate, compared to **55.6%** for the control group.

An absolute improvement of nearly 5 percent represented a highly significant ($p<0.001$, z-test for proportions) increase in the proportion submitting, as measured by z-test.

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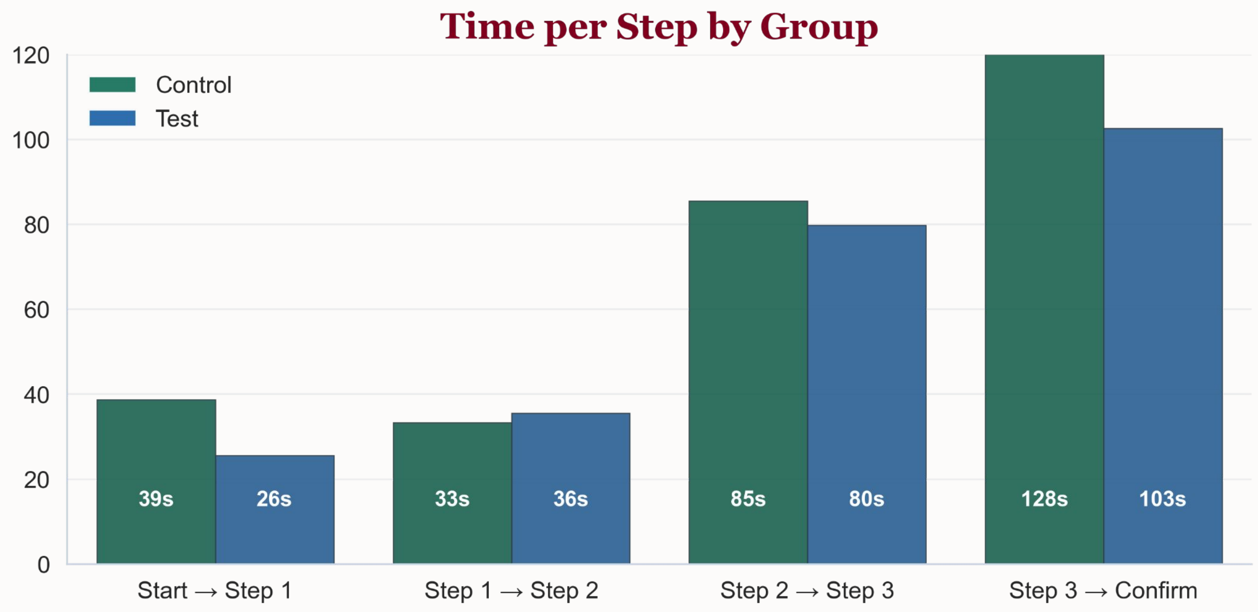
# DECREASED COMPLETION TIME ACROSS STEPS

## Completers finished significantly faster.

Users in the test group spent 17% less time on task. They were significantly faster transitioning to Steps 1, 3 and Confirm ($p<0.001$, t-test).

Median completion time dropped from **235 seconds** in the control group to **195 seconds** in the test group—saving users an average of 40 seconds.

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# COMPLETION TIME

T-test results per step (Test vs Control):

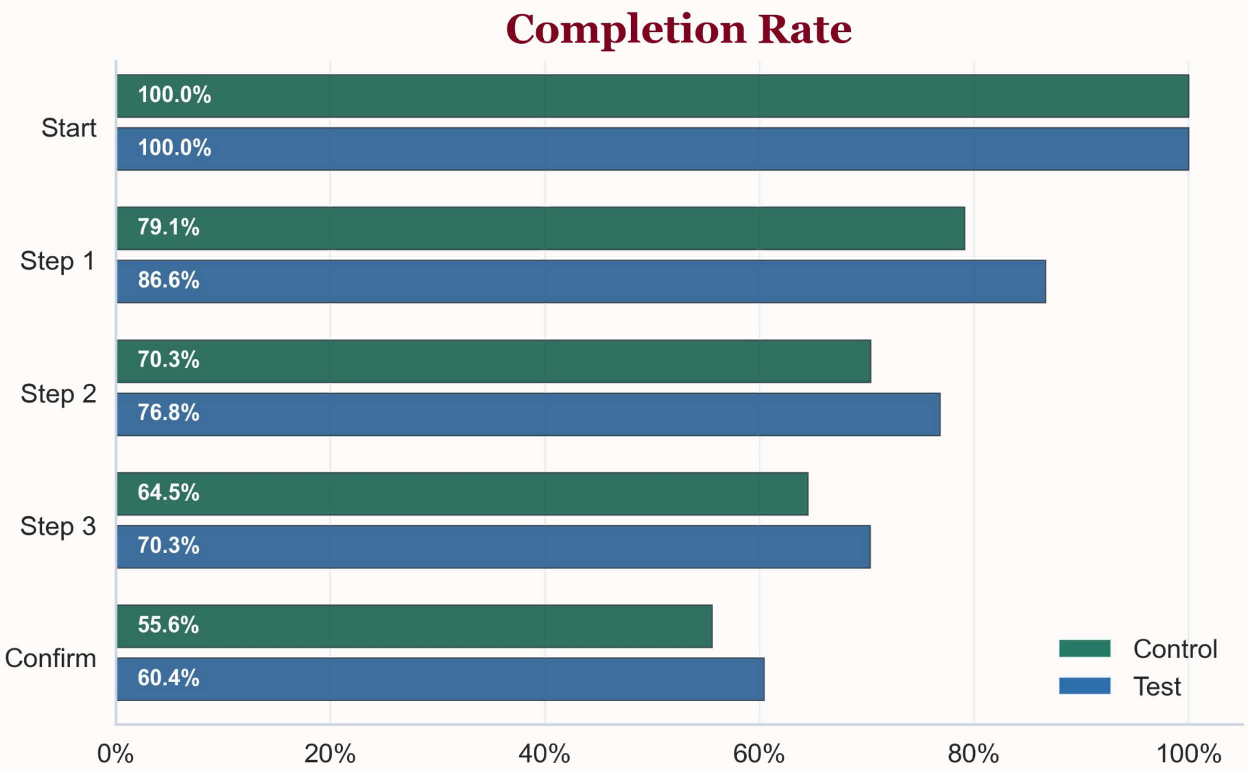
| Step | p-value | Significant? |
|---|---|---|
| Start → Step 1 | 9.7e-09 | Yes |
| Step 1 → Step 2 | 0.159 | No |
| Step 2 → Step 3 | 2.3e-05 | Yes |
| Step 3 → Confirm | 2.0e-43 | Yes |

# DECREASED DROP-OFF RATES VS. CONTROL

### Where does the difference come from?

If we look at user progress step-by-step, the test group shows higher retention rate at Step 1 and carries that margin across all subsequent transitions.

We saw a significant increase in retention across all transitions ($p<0.001$, z-test for proportions).



# THE ERROR RATE PARADOX

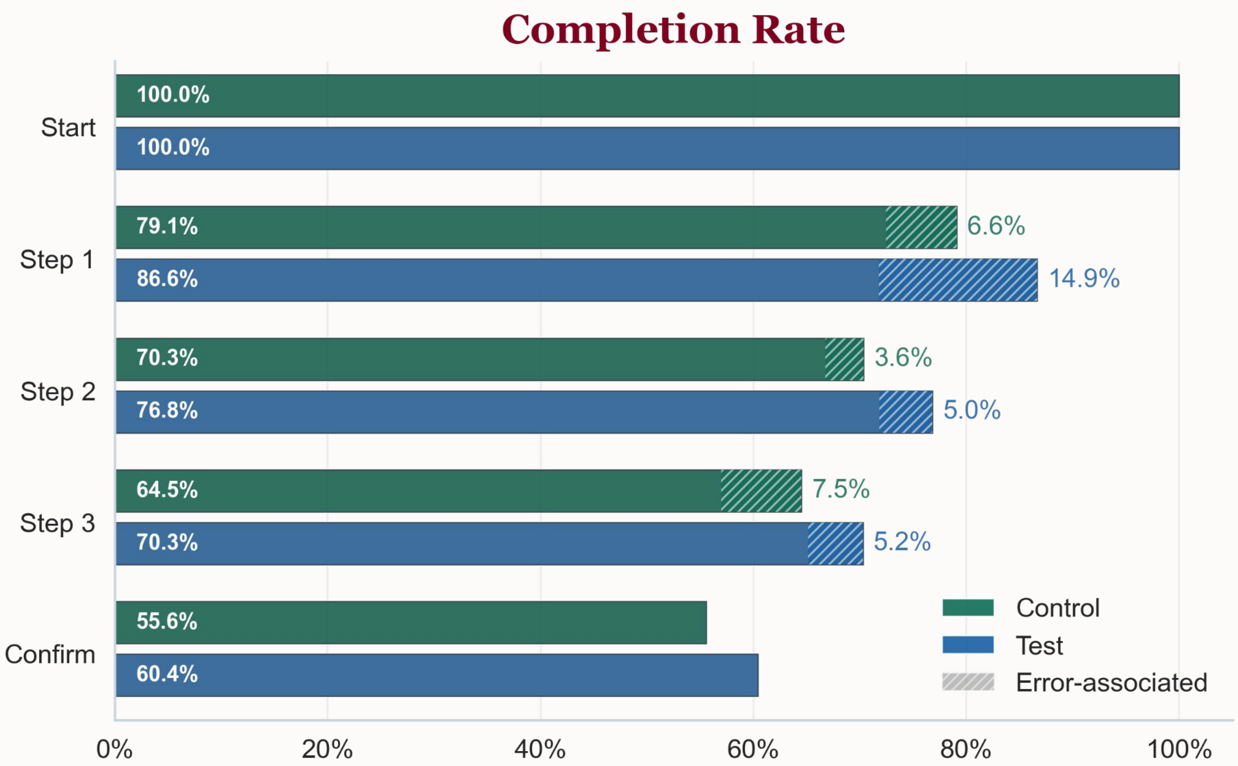
## Why did the test group do so much better at the first step?

When examining **error rate**, we uncovered an interesting trend: at the Start to Step 1 transition, the test group had over twice as many errors as the control group (14.9% vs. 6.6%).

Decreases in error rates were highly significant across three major transition steps (p<0.001, z-test for proportions). Drop-off rates differed within conditions (p<0.001, chi-squared test).

### The Backtracking Behavior

Even though test group users hit more errors, dropout decreased from 20.9% to 13.4%. The new layout and in-context prompts allowed users to make mistakes, fix them, and continue, rather than giving up.

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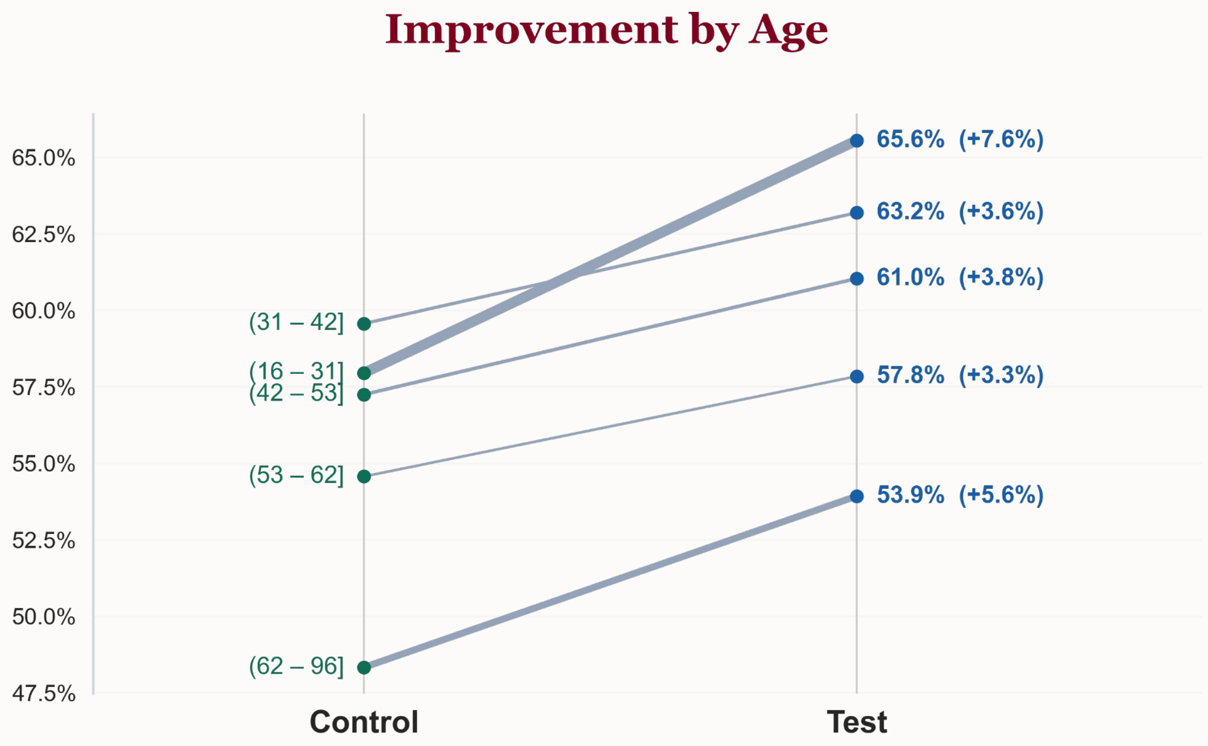
# IMPROVEMENTS ACROSS ALL AGE GROUPS

Modifying layouts may alienate older clients who might be more accustomed to legacy designs.

The data shows that **all ages benefited** from the test layout. But particularly more vulnerable older or younger customers.

Decreases in error rate and number of errors were most pronounced (p<0.001 across all groups). Increases in completion were also highly significant (p<0.01 for 53-62. p<0.001 for all other quintiles, z-test for proportions).

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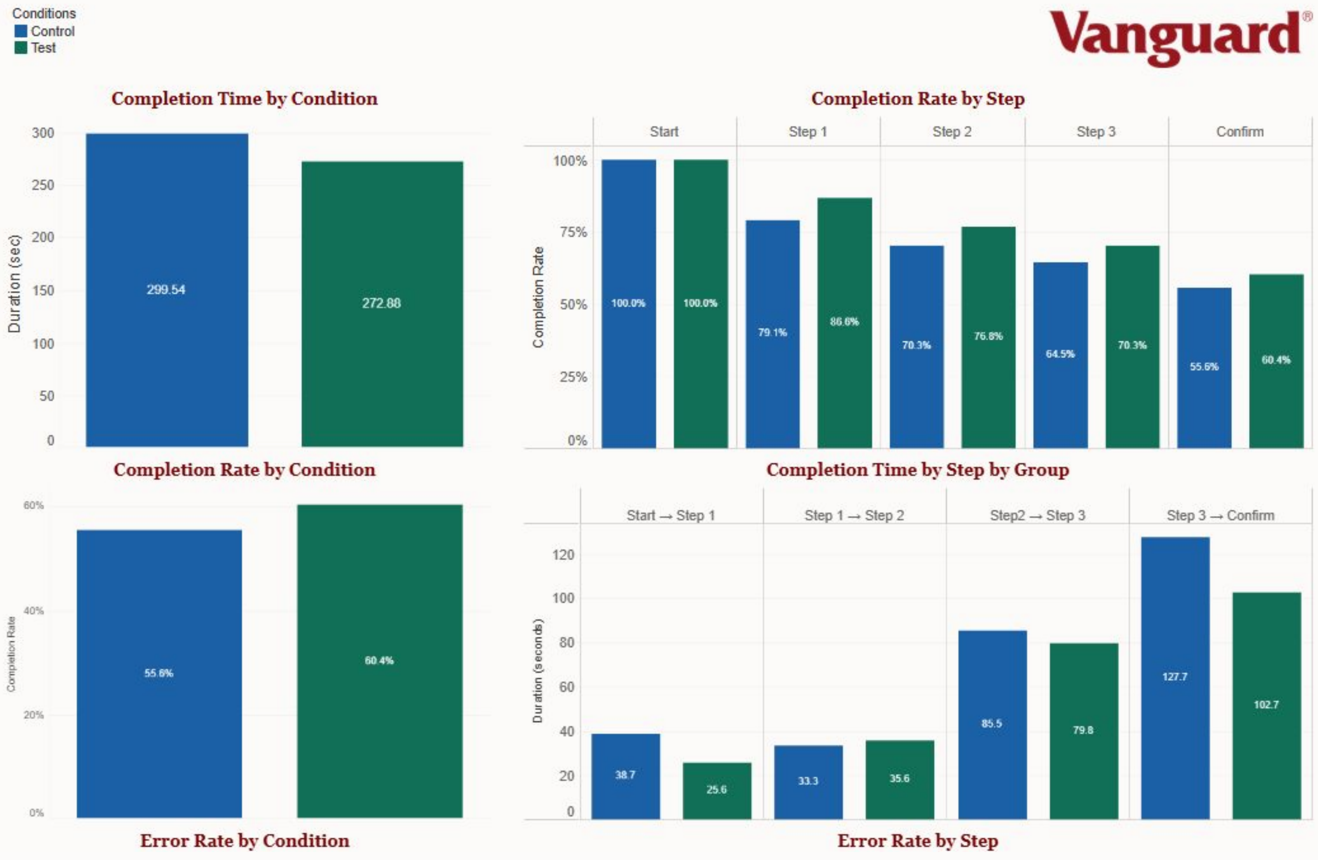
# OTHER KPIs & TABLEAU DASHBOARD

The test UI significantly **improved completion rates for both male and female clients** ($p<0.001$, z-test for proportions).

It was also **effective across all balance quintiles** ($p<0.001$, z-test for proportions), suggesting the effect is robust across key demographic segments.

Data and figures relating to the A/B test can be found on [Tableau.](Tableau.)



# NEXT STEPS

**Implement Rollout**
Though the 4.9 percent increase failed to meet the threshold of 5 percent for cost-effectiveness, we recommend rolling out the test interface to all users due to highly significant results.

**Encourage Course-Correction**
The data shows that allowing users to easily recover from errors early in the process prevents them from abandoning the task entirely.

**Decrease Error Rates**
While the testing resolved the drop-outs, investigating the causes of errors and abandonment throughout the process should be the next priority.


## Summary

This test demonstrates that clear layouts and in-context hints help clients succeed.

By helping clients self-correct on their own terms, we successfully increased completion, reduced time on task, and simplified the overall client experience.

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# Questions & Discussion

Claire & Bibian

Ironhack Data Analytics | May 2026